exemplified these efforts, aiming to guarantee equitable access to diagnostics, treatments, and vaccines, particularly for developing countries (Moon et al. 2022).

Funding posed a significant challenge, but the WHO adapted by seeking support from other member states. The EU stepped up with additional financial contributions, and the WHO launched an unprecedented open-investment round to broaden its donor base and secure more predictable and flexible funding streams (Schuette and Dijkstra 2023). This initiative marked a turning point, reducing the organization's reliance on volatile member states like the United States and strengthening its financial resilience.[61]

Despite these efforts to sideline US disengagement, the WHO also sought to appease Trump. In response to his demands for an investigation into the origins of COVID-19, the WHO convened the Global Study of the Origins of SARS-CoV-2 in 2020. The EU, too, advocated reforms designed to address US concerns, including calls for increased transparency, an independent on-site epidemiological assessment mechanism, and revisions to the system for declaring "Public Health Emergencies of International Concern" (Schuette and Dijkstra 2023). These measures were intended to assuage US skepticism and encourage re-engagement.

WHO director general Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus also took to social media to combat Trump's criticisms and rally international support. In a strategic shift, Tedros began retweeting endorsements from influential figures like Melinda Gates and former US president Jimmy Carter, as well as supportive statements from other member countries and peer IOs.[62] He emphasized messages of unity and resilience, aiming to strengthen public perception of the WHO as an essential actor in global health.[63] Behind the scenes, White House staff maintained occasional contact with WHO officials, although the specifics of these discussions remain unclear. These private meetings suggest an effort by the WHO to work around Trump's public antagonism and sideline domestic constituents while keeping lines of communication open.

Ultimately, while the WHO's strategies did not succeed in reversing Trump's decision to withdraw, they secured vital support from other international actors. The organization managed to weather the crisis by diversifying its funding sources, leveraging global partnerships, and